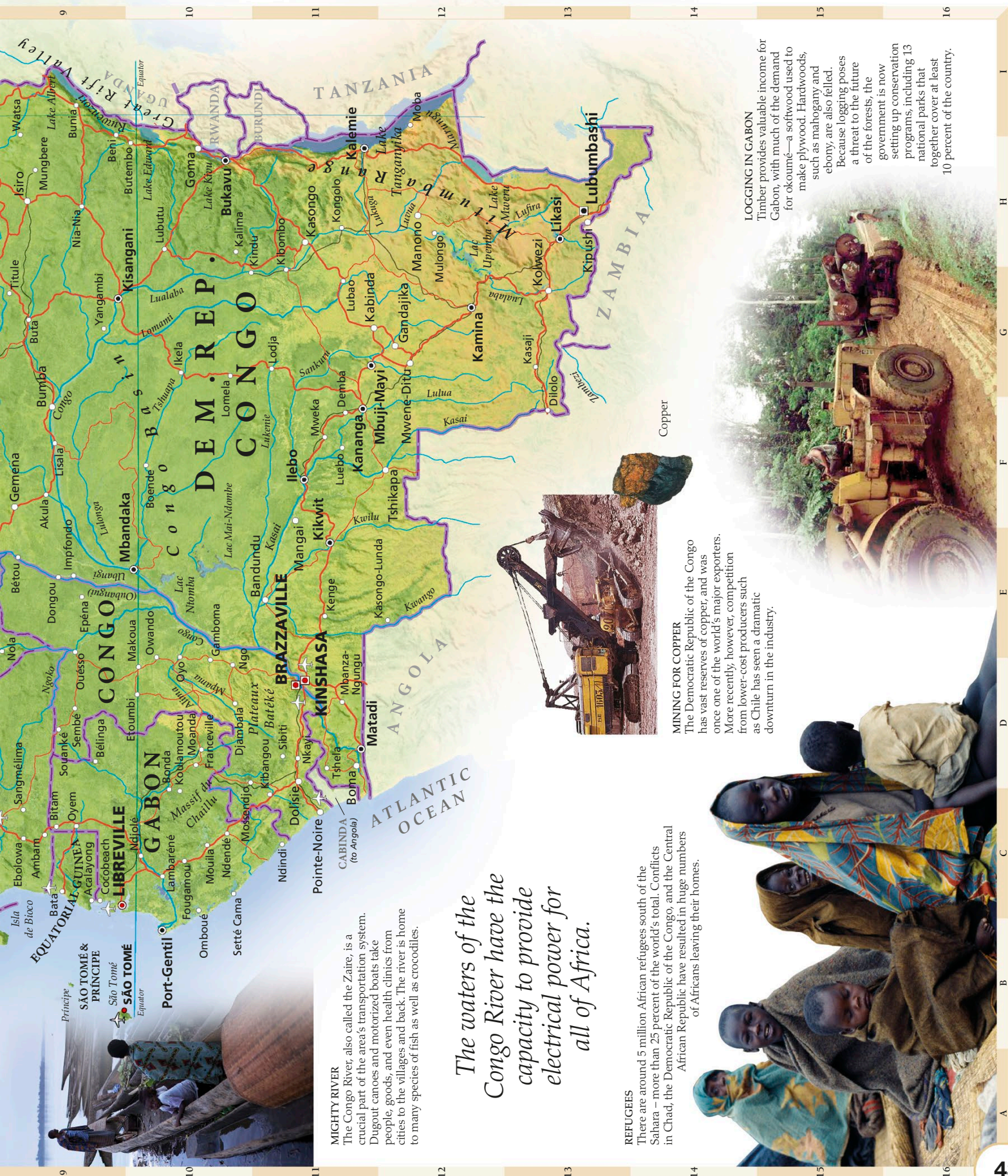




MIGHTY RIVER

The Congo River, also called the Zaire, is a crucial part of the area's transportation system. Dugout canoes and motorized boats take people, goods, and even health clinics from cities to the villages and back. The river is home to many species of fish as well as crocodiles.

The waters of the Congo River have the capacity to provide electrical power for all of Africa.

REFUGEES

There are around 5 million African refugees south of the Sahara – more than 25 percent of the world's total. Conflicts in Chad, the Democratic Republic of the Congo, and the Central African Republic have resulted in huge numbers of Africans leaving their homes.



MINING FOR COPPER

The Democratic Republic of the Congo has vast reserves of copper, and was once one of the world's major exporters. More recently, however, competition from lower-cost producers such as Chile has seen a dramatic downturn in the industry.



Copper

LOGGING IN GABON

Timber provides valuable income for Gabon, with much of the demand for okoumé—a softwood used to make plywood. Hardwoods, such as mahogany and ebony, are also felled.

Because logging poses a threat to the future of the forests, the government is now setting up conservation programs, including 13 national parks that together cover at least 10 percent of the country.

